

PA Faculty Job Market: Candidate Pulse — October 2026

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Monthly pulse check for PhD candidates — October 6, 2026

I've picked up one new PA / PP tenure-track posting since the previous snapshot (2026-10-05), at University of North Florida. Across all ranks, the PA and PP panels added a net 1 *canonical* posting (de-duplicated — one row per real search after merging cross-postings) since 2026-10-05. We're in the fall window. October volume sits below the July–August peak; most active searches now are carry-overs nearing decision.

What's changed since 2026-10-05

Metric	Previous	Current	Change
Assistant Professor TT postings (PA + PP)	112	113	+1
PA postings (all ranks, canonical)	324	325	+1
Political science postings (canonical)	523	530	+7
Canonical postings (all disciplines)	20,151	20,278	+127
OpenAlex author profiles linked	627	628	+1
Career observations	41,405	48,308	+6,903

New PA / PP tenure-track postings

Tenure-track searches I first observed since the previous snapshot (2026-10-05), split by rank. Assistant Professor is the slot most first-time TT candidates are targeting; senior or open-rank searches are useful context for where the field is moving. Click any title to open the listing.

Assistant Professor

Title	Institution	Location
Assistant Professor	University of North Florida	FL

How we're doing relative to expectations

I don't have a clean year-over-year comparison for September 2026 yet — the live scrapers came online in April 2026, so prior years are Wayback-sampled and thin. The seasonality shape in the figure below is still the right calibration tool; year-over-year context sharpens as more cycles accumulate. The chart below shows the underlying shape: PA and PP postings stacked by calendar month, pooled across the complete sampled years (2016–2025). I recommend candidates use it as a calibration tool. Volume arrives in *two waves* — the larger in July–August and a second in January (each about 13% of the year) — while **May and December are the two dead months** (roughly 1% each). Read the comparison above against this typical pattern to see where the current cycle sits.

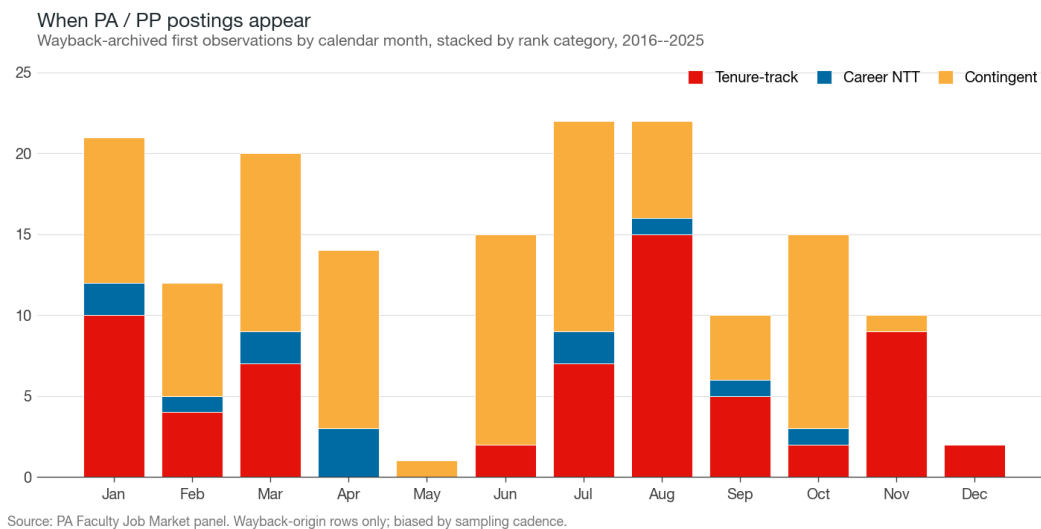


Figure 1. Stacked PA + PP postings by calendar month, complete sampled years (2016–2025). Two waves — July–August (largest) and January — with May and December the dead months (~1% each).

Suggestions

This pulse is a work in progress, and I'd genuinely like to hear what's not landing for you. If something's missing, miscounted, mis-framed, or just unclear, let me know — the panel and the prose both get better when I know what readers actually want. A short feedback form is in the works; in the meantime, [click here](#) to open a reply with the right subject line pre-filled, or just reply to this email directly.

For the full picture

I keep this monthly pulse intentionally short. The companion annual *Candidate Edition* carries the rest of the analysis: the three-cluster placement typology, productivity trajectories by

placement type, top destinations, geography, subfields in demand, and the methodological transparency you need to interpret the headline numbers. I update it once per year, typically in summer ahead of the new application cycle — reply if you’d like the latest copy.

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*Candidate Edition (monthly). The annual Candidate Edition and the annual Institutional Edition are posted separately. This monthly pulse regenerates on the first of each month from the **faculty_market_analysis** panel. Build system: Claude Code (Anthropic).*